4 LETTERING & DIMENSIONING

INTRODUCTION

Lettering is an important feature in Engineering drawings. Writing of titles and subtitles of drawings , dimensioning the parts of the objects drawn, writing the scale and other details is called dimensioning . As the use of instrument for lettering will consume more time, it is very essential to do lettering free hand with speed, neatness, and beauty of form.

The requirements of lettering, namely types and sizes of letters and techniques of lettering are specified in IS 9609- 1983(Lettering for technical Drawings)

IMPORTANCE OF LETTERING

Neatness , legibility, uniformity, suitability for microfilming and photocopying are the main feature of lettering . Poor lettering will spoil the appearance of a drawing and lead to wrong results. Lettering is the talk of the drawing and so it very important that it is done correctly to finish the drawing completely.

PROPORTIONS OF LETTERING

There is no specified proportions for each letter of alphabets lettering. Considering uniformity, a proportions between the height and the width is to be followed. There are three proportions by which lettering can be done best. They are

1. NORMAL LETTERING
2. CONDENSED LETTERING
3. EXTENDED LETTERING

Normal lettering will have normal height and width and finds application in general use. Condensed lettering has shortened width with respect to its height and is used where space available is limited. Extended lettering will have more width and normal height.

SPACING OF LETTERS

The distance left between two adjacent letters while lettering is known as spacing of letters. Equal spaces have to be left between letters for better appearance. Spacing is judged by observation and done by practice.